FY2023 Studies

Social Service Sector Survey on Volunteer Management examined the state of volunteer management practices across social service agencies, with a focus on identifying best practices and persistent challenges in volunteer recruitment, retention, and recognition. Findings from this study informed subsequent development of the Volunteer Management Maturity Matrix.

Digital Acceleration Index (DAI) assessed the digital maturity of SSAs across key domains including infrastructure, data management, and digital service delivery. The study established a baseline for tracking the sector's digital transformation progress over time.

Volunteer Compliance with the Personal Data Protection Act (PDPA) investigated the extent to which volunteers across SSAs adhere to PDPA requirements in the course of their service, identifying gaps in awareness, training, and organisational oversight.

Review of Experiences and Effectiveness of the Employer Support Grant evaluated how SSAs have utilised the Employer Support Grant, gathering feedback on its accessibility, adequacy, and impact on employment outcomes for persons with disabilities and other vulnerable groups.

Review of Peer Support Strategy and Peer Support Specialist (PSS) Training examined the effectiveness of NCSS' PSS training and practicum structure, with the aim of identifying areas for enhancement in curriculum design, supervision, and deployment of peer support specialists across the sector.

4ST Perception Poll obtained benchmark measurements on the adoption of the four strategic thrusts (4ST) across the sector, providing an indication of agencies' awareness of and progress towards sector-wide strategic priorities.

Board Evaluation Survey gathered feedback from board members and agency leadership on governance practices, board effectiveness, and areas for capacity building, contributing to NCSS' broader organisational development support efforts.

Organisational Health Framework for Social Services (OHFSS) Self-Assessment Form enabled SSAs to assess their own organisational health across multiple dimensions, including leadership, people management, financial sustainability, and service quality.

NCSS Survey on Organisational Development collected feedback from SSAs on the adequacy and relevance of NCSS' current support for organisational development, informing future programming and resource allocation.

Volunteer Impact Assessment Framework (VIAF) sought to develop a common language and measurement framework for assessing the impact of volunteerism and volunteer management across SSAs. The framework was designed to support a data-driven approach to volunteer management and to communicate the value of volunteerism to funders, corporate donors, and the broader public.

Volunteer Management Maturity Matrix (VMM Matrix) Analysis identified gaps in volunteer management practices among SSAs by mapping agencies against a maturity model, enabling targeted support and benchmarking across the sector.

Insights on Sector Awareness and Engagement Efforts deepened understanding of public and stakeholder awareness of social sector jobs and career opportunities, informing NCSS' outreach and communications strategies for workforce development.

Evaluation of Project SAFE 1.1 assessed the effectiveness of counselling services provided to drug addicts and their families under Project SAFE, with a focus on strengthening family resilience and evaluating programme outcomes.

Insight into the Sector's Fund Raising Capability examined the fundraising capacity of SSAs, identifying gaps in skills, systems, and strategies, and informing recommendations for sector-wide capability building in this area.

FY2024 Studies

Stakeholder Study explored stakeholders' perceptions of NCSS as an organisation, providing insights to guide brand strategy development and strategic communications planning.

Digital Acceleration Index (DAI) continued the annual tracking of digital maturity across SSAs, enabling year-on-year comparison and identification of agencies requiring targeted digital support.

Organisational Health Framework for Social Services (OHFSS) Self-Assessment Form was administered for a second cycle, allowing for longitudinal tracking of organisational health trends across the sector.

Insights on Sector Awareness and Engagement Efforts built on the FY2023 study with updated data on public and stakeholder perceptions of social sector careers and opportunities.

Training Needs Survey assessed the current and emerging training needs of SSAs on an annual basis, informing the design and prioritisation of NCSS' learning and development programmes.

VM Research Study and the accompanying **Social Sector Survey on Volunteer Management** provided updated data on volunteer management practices, building on the FY2023 baseline and tracking progress against identified gaps.

Empowering for Life (ELF) Impact Study evaluated the outcomes of fund programmes supporting vulnerable populations — including children and youths, adults, persons with disabilities, persons with mental health conditions, seniors, and ex-offenders — in the areas of skills upgrading, capacity building, and employment.

Board Evaluation Survey was conducted for a second cycle, enabling longitudinal tracking of governance practices and board effectiveness across SSAs.

4ST Perception Poll provided updated benchmark measurements on sector progress towards the four strategic thrusts, enabling comparison with the FY2023 baseline.

Volunteer Management Maturity Matrix (VMMM) refined and applied the maturity model developed in FY2023, tracking changes in volunteer management practices and identifying agencies ready for more advanced support.

Learning and Development Roadmap for Volunteer Management Practitioners (VMPs) Self-Assessment Tool enabled VMPs to assess their own competencies and identify development priorities, supporting a more structured approach to professional development in volunteer management.

SDT's Study on Tech Stack in Homes examined the technology infrastructure and digital tools in use across residential care homes, identifying gaps and opportunities for technology-enabled service improvement.

CNPL's Board Leadership Study investigated board leadership practices within the social service sector, with a focus on governance effectiveness, leadership diversity, and succession planning.

Empowerment Service Design Module and Checklist evaluated the usability and effectiveness of empowerment-focused service design tools developed for SSAs, gathering practitioner feedback to refine the module for wider rollout.

Volunteer Impact Assessment Framework (VIAF) continued its development and piloting phase, with selected agencies testing the framework in practice and providing feedback on its applicability and utility.

Organisational Health Diagnostic Scheme (OHDS) complemented the OHFSS self-assessment with an externally facilitated diagnostic process for agencies seeking deeper organisational development support.

Developmental Evaluation of Collective Impact Projects assessed the progress and early outcomes of two collective impact initiatives — SHINE's Integrated Wellness

Centre and the Bukit Merah project — providing formative insights to guide ongoing implementation.

MyAIMS User Discovery explored the user experience of the MyAIMS platform among SSA staff, identifying usability issues and feature gaps to inform product development priorities.

Sector Perception Study on Social Sector Professionals examined how social sector professionals are perceived by the public, employers, and other stakeholders, informing workforce attraction and retention strategies.

Study on Work Conditions of Social Sector Professionals gathered data on the working conditions, job satisfaction, and wellbeing of social sector professionals, providing an evidence base for sector-wide workforce policy recommendations.

FY2025 Studies

Survey on Social Sector Development (SSS) was administered to SSAs as part of the annual data collection cycle, tracking key indicators of sector health including workforce, financials, service delivery, and organisational capacity.

Membership Renewal Survey (MRS) gathered feedback from NCSS member agencies on their membership experience, the value of NCSS' services and programmes, and priorities for the year ahead.

Organisational Health Framework for Social Services (OHFSS) Self-Assessment Form continued its annual cycle, enabling ongoing tracking of organisational health trends across the sector.

Volunteer Management Maturity Matrix (VMMM) was administered for a third cycle, providing longitudinal data on the evolution of volunteer management practices across SSAs.

MyAIMS User Discovery continued to gather user feedback on the MyAIMS platform, tracking improvements made in response to FY2024 findings and identifying new areas for development.

Sector Perception on Social Sector Professionals provided updated data on public and stakeholder perceptions of social sector careers, enabling year-on-year tracking of awareness and sentiment.

Stakeholder Pulse Survey captured timely feedback from a broad range of stakeholders — including the general public, institutes of higher learning, and private and public sector partners — on their awareness of and engagement with the social service sector.

CNLP's Board Leadership Study continued the longitudinal examination of board leadership practices, tracking changes since the FY2024 baseline and assessing the impact of capacity building interventions.

FY2026 Studies

Survey on Social Sector Development continued the annual SSA data collection cycle, maintaining longitudinal tracking of sector-wide indicators.

Digital Maturity Index (TBC) is proposed as an evolution of the Digital Acceleration Index, with a refined methodology to more comprehensively assess digital maturity across SSAs in line with the sector's advancing digital landscape.

Organisational Health Framework for Social Services (OHFSS) Self-Assessment Form and the **Volunteer Management Maturity Matrix (VMMM)** continued their respective annual cycles.

MyAIMS User Discovery maintained its ongoing user research function in support of platform development.

Stakeholder Perception Pulse Survey was expanded in FY2026 to include social sector professionals as a sample group, providing a more integrated view of stakeholder sentiment.

SGSHARE Performance evaluated the performance and uptake of the SGSHARE platform, assessing its effectiveness as a resource-sharing tool for the social service sector.

Brand Health Study assessed the health of the NCSS brand across key stakeholder groups, tracking awareness, perception, and trust over time.

NCSS Social Service Tribe CNA Docuseries evaluation examined the reach, reception, and impact of the docuseries as a public communications and sector awareness initiative.

President's Challenge study assessed the outcomes and community impact of President's Challenge-funded programmes and initiatives across the sector.

Donor User Service Journey mapped the end-to-end experience of donors engaging with NCSS and SSAs, identifying friction points and opportunities to improve donor engagement and retention.

User Journey on Social Media Addiction (TBC) is a proposed study examining the experiences of individuals and families affected by social media addiction, informing the design of appropriate social service interventions.